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## **Executive Summary**

*This section is a summary of the information from the pages that follow. Prepare it last, after the business plan has been written. It should not exceed two pages. Headings to use in the Executive Summary:*

- A. Vision/Mission Statement*
- B. Company Summary*
- C. Products/Services*
- D. Market Assessment*
- E. Strategic Implementation*
- F. Expected Outcomes*

## **Vision/Mission Statement and Goals**

### **A. Vision Statement**

*The vision/mission statements are clear summaries of where the business is headed. It describes what the business produces, who products are produced for, and unique business characteristics. It will reflect the values of the management team and the type of business culture you are trying to create.*

### **B. Goals and Objectives**

*What do you want your business to achieve? Be specific in terms of financial performance, resource commitments (time and money) and risk.  
When will various milestones be achieved?*

### **C. Keys to Success**

*What do you need, or must happen, for you to succeed?*

## Company Summary

*The material in this section is an introduction to the firm.*

### **A. Company Background**

*What does your business do?*

*Who were the founders of the business?*

*What were the important milestones in the development of the business?*

### **B. Resources, Facilities and Equipment**

*With what do you produce your products or services?*

*What are the land, equipment, human and financial resources?*

*Who provides them?*

*How are resource providers rewarded?*

### **C. Marketing Methods**

*What is your annual sales volume in dollars and units?*

*Explain how you work with others to improve returns. This may include a strategic alliance with suppliers or customers that you can leverage.*

*Do you use forward contracting, options, or futures? If so, how?*

*How much does it cost to produce and deliver your products and services?*

*How is contracting used?*

### **D. Management and Organization**

*Who is currently on the management team?*

*How have management responsibilities been divided among the management team?*

*What are the lines of authority?*

*Who acts as the president/CEO? spokesperson? Chief Financial Officer?*

*Who determines employees' salaries and conducts performance reviews?*

*What is the educational background of the management team members?*

*What is the management team's reputation in the community?*

*What special skills and abilities does the management team have?*

*What additional skills does the management team need?*

*Who are the key people and personnel that make your business run?*

*Who do you go to for advice and support?*

*Do management and employees have avenues for personal development?*

*Sketch a diagram of lines of authority for your operation.*

### **E. Ownership Structure**

*Who are the primary stakeholders in your business?*

*Describe the legal form of your company, such as partnership, proprietorship, or corporation.*

*Do you need special permits to operate, or a record for inspections? If you do, please describe them.*